Kestrel Bay Fishing Co.

Harbour Office, 7 Quayside, Kestrel Bay, KB9 3DF | www.kestrelbayfishing-example.co.uk

Boat Hand / Deckhand — Inshore Fishing Vessel

Reference: REF: KBF-DK-2026-004

Location:	Kestrel Bay Harbour (vessel-based, daily returns)
Vessel:	FV 'Morvoren' — 12m inshore potting & netting boat
Reports to:	Skipper / Owner
Contract:	Seasonal to permanent (April–December, trial month initially)
Pay:	£110–£140 per day at sea, plus share of catch bonus
Start date:	September 2026

About Us

Kestrel Bay Fishing Co. is a small family-run operation working the inshore grounds off the south coast. Our 12-metre vessel, the FV Morvoren, targets crab, lobster, bass and pollack using pots, tangle nets and handlines, landing daily to local merchants and restaurants. We are a two-person crew — skipper plus one — so the boat hand is a genuine working partner, not an extra pair of hands.

The Role

We need a reliable boat hand to join us for the autumn and winter potting season, with the prospect of a permanent berth for the right person. The work is physical, wet and early — we typically leave the quay at 04:30 and are back alongside by mid-afternoon, weather permitting. No two days are the same, and you will learn every part of running a small working fishing boat.

Key Responsibilities

- Haul, bait, stack and shoot crab and lobster pots (strings of 20–30 pots)
- Handle, grade, band and store shellfish; gut, ice and box finfish to merchant standard
- Shoot and haul tangle nets and work handlines when in season
- Carry out deck wash-downs, basic engine checks and routine maintenance of pots, ropes and buoys ashore
- Assist with mooring, anchoring and watch-keeping under the skipper's direction
- Keep the catch tally and help complete landing declarations
- Follow all vessel safety procedures, including wearing PPE and participating in man-overboard drills
- Help with occasional deliveries to local fish merchants and restaurants

Essential Requirements

- Physically fit and comfortable with heavy, repetitive manual work in all weathers
- Sea legs — previous time on boats strongly preferred (commercial, leisure or sea angling all count)
- Reliable and punctual — the boat sails on tide times, and a late arrival costs a day's fishing
- Basic numeracy for catch tallies and grading
- Willing to work early starts (typically 04:00) and long days when the weather window allows
- No history of severe seasickness that would prevent working offshore in moderate seas

Desirable (Not Essential)

- STCW Basic Safety Training / Sea Survival certificate (or willingness to complete — costs covered after trial month)
- RYA Powerboat Level 2 or similar small-boat handling experience
- Experience with potting, netting or shellfish grading
- Full clean driving licence (for merchant deliveries)

What We Offer

- All waterproofs, boots and PPE provided
- Daily catch bonus on top of day rate (typically adds 10–20% over a season)
- Paid training: Sea Survival and First Aid at Sea after successful trial
- Flexible winter lay-off period January–March by agreement
- Pathway to skippering your own trips once experienced

How to Apply

Email crew@kestrelbayfishing-example.co.uk with a short note about your experience and availability, quoting reference KBF-DK-2026-004. We hire on a paid trial-day basis: shortlisted candidates come out for one full day's fishing before we agree terms.

Closing date: Friday 28 August 2026 (rolling until filled)

SYNTHETIC SAMPLE DOCUMENT — created for CV-screening software testing only. This organisation, vacancy and contact details are fictional.